This Love

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31201841.

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by cabbageboy

Summary

It's Mother's Day, and Adora takes it upon herself to celebrate with her family.

Notes

A quick little Mother's Day fic because I felt like throwing it together and I also just really wanted to write something cute and fluffy.

The one where Adora started dating Catra a little less than a year ago and this is their first Mother's Day together.

Catra and Finn are cat people in this because um *windows startup noise* kitten purr make brain go brrrr

Catra sat up against the headboard, ear twitching at the sound of footsteps coming down the hall. There are giggles, followed by a hush as the footsteps stop, and soon there are even *more* giggles as they continue toward the door. It's still pretty early for a weekend, a Sunday especially. It was normal for her and Adora to stay in bed, pressing kisses to each other's faces and necks, languid strokes up and down each other's backs, until they heard little footsteps approaching the door and pulled apart just in time to receive a bouncing Finn falling to the mattress between them.

So when she had woken up to an empty bed and a commotion down the hall (that her two dorks tried their best to get under control) it took her a second to remember what day it was.

A soft knock is quickly followed by the creak of the door swinging open to reveal her little family; her child and the woman who had quickly solidified her place in Catra's heart as the love of her life.

"Happy Mother's Day Mommy! We made breakfast!" Finn's squeaky little voice makes her smile softly.

No one was more shocked than her by just how well she had taken to motherhood, just how much she loved her baby. It was kind of astounding to think back at how little they had started out. Watching them grow from a kitten, ears folded down and unable to even open their eyes, into the child in front of her seemed like a miracle. They're standing just at hip height now, holding a vase with flowers that is almost as tall as they are, smiling brightly.

"You made breakfast? That sounds wonderful," She says, reaching out to take the flowers and place them on her bedside table. As soon as their hands are free, Finn lunges forward to crawl up into bed, needle sharp claws pulling at the comforter, and sit next to her. Their tail thumps wildly on the bed, ears perked forward and lips pulled wide. It shows off the gap where one of their teeth was missing, and it's just about the most beautiful thing she's ever seen.

She combs her fingers through their hair and purrs affectionately, leaning down to bump her nose against their head. Their resounding ‘mrrrp’ pulls at her heart.

“Yeah, ‘Dora helped me make it. It’s your favorite!”

Catra turns to see Adora and rolls her eyes goodnaturedly at the watery sheen sparkling over the blue grey. It was no secret that Adora thought Catra and Finn together were the cutest sight in the world.

“Hey, Adora.”

The phrase jolts her into action and she’s leaning down to place the tray on the bed, right in front of Catra but with enough room for her to sit down on the edge as well. As soon as she’s seated, Finn is clamoring across the bed and into her lap.

Catra has to bite her lip not to laugh at the little smiley face the two goobers made out of the bacon and eggs.

“Happy Mother’s Day, baby,” Adora whispers, ghosting a feather light kiss across Catra’s own forehead.

“You didn’t have to do all of this for me, you know. I know work has been a lot and you got home really late last night. You didn’t have to get up early for me.”

Adora just shakes her head and nuzzles between Finn’s ears.

“Well if you think I am going to let our first Mother’s Day together pass without making a BIG celebration of it, you must not know me at all.”

She hadn’t ever let on that the holiday used to be a little sore, especially when it was just her and Finn. They appreciated her, but it was a whole other feeling to have a partner now that acknowledged it, that vocalized how important it was, how important she was.

While their relationship was just getting toward the year mark, it was clear by not only their connection, but the relationship Adora had cultivated with Finn, that they were really heavily leaning toward 'forever.' It felt like it all happened at once, really. One second they were going on one date every week or so, and the next it seemed as though they were seeing each other every day. Adora moved the last of her things in just over a month ago, in fact.

Catra was worried about how Finn would take the new addition to their lives, and how Adora would react to meeting the child, but it turned out that those worries were irrelevant when it came down to it.

A few weeks into their relationship, after they had made it official, Adora had suggested a 'family date' at Catra's house to get Finn used to the idea of having her around. It was just going to be a casual lunch, but turned into a playdate that lasted through the afternoon and into the evening.

As soon as Adora got there she dropped everything and climbed up to join Finn in the massive oak tree in the backyard and from then on there wasn't a moment that the atmosphere lacked wild giggles and deep laughter. The way it made Catra's heart feel full, genuinely and truly full, wasn't a feeling she would take for granted.

Later into the night, after she had gotten Finn bathed and wrestled them into pajamas, she'd walked back into the living room to find that Adora had cleaned the kitchen in her absence, and was now pulling one of her favorite childhood books out of her bag.

"Are they asleep yet? I brought a bedtime story, if that's ok."

It was not the first time, even that day, that she'd cried.

It also wasn't the last, because moments later when Adora sat down on Finn's bed and they crawled into her lap to purr softly

against her chest, tucked into their blanket, she'd practically sobbed.

She's brought back to the present by a giggle, and looks up to where Adora is sitting there with Finn in her lap, tickling their tummy. She's just so gentle with the child, and something stirs deep in her chest.

"So, what are we going to do today?" She asks.

She finished her breakfast while they went back and forth talking adamantly about their plans for the special day.

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Just when she didn't think her heart could get any more full, Adora takes them to the new climbing gym in town. The location had just opened up, a new branch of a gym that Adora went to in her college town, and she's excited to share it with Finn especially.

She can tell she hits the mark when their jaw goes slack and their eyes widen, pupils dilating and tail thrashing back and forth. Their little hands are shaking with excitement and they're bouncing on the balls of their feet.

Adora scans her member card at the front and pays for the guests and the harness rentals before leading them back to the locker room to put her bag away.

"Ok kiddo, just put your feet through there," She says, sliding the straps of the harness up to rest around their hips and pulling it tight gently. She's kneeling in front of them on one knee, and it really shows just how small they are compared to her.

She gives the harness a tug to test the straps and wiggles her fingers beneath it to make sure it isn't too tight.

"Why do I have to wear it?" They ask as she moves to stand up. She stays crouched there at their level for a moment longer.

“There are a couple of reasons. The big one is so you don’t get hurt. I know you don’t need it, you’re an *amazing* climber and I know you won’t fall, but it is still really high and even though there are mats on the ground it's still a really hard fall. I don’t want you to get hurt. Plus it’s the gym’s policy, even for species besides humans. Another big one is that when you’re up there it is a little hard to keep track of where you are so the harness and rope keep you in a specific lane so that you don’t climb to the side into the way of someone using a path next to you.”

The explanation seems to satisfy them, and Catra is thankful that Adora has always been so upfront with them. A lot of adults fell back on ‘because I said so’ or ‘because those are the rules’ and nothing took the steam out of a child like being treated as though they weren’t worth the effort of a real explanation. Adora always treated them like they deserved to really know what was going on. She never looked at Finn like someone that deserved to be talked down to.

Adora didn’t have a lot of experience with kids before Finn, and hadn’t expected someone so young to already be so unique. It really was so special to have a kid like them in her life.

She turns to her bag and pulls out a little helmet.

They groan.

“Ugh, why do I need a helmet?”

Catra smirks at the scene. Her little Finn had every bit the attitude that she did.

“Because if you fall, I want to protect that smart brain of yours.”

They roll their eyes but allow her to put the helmet on. She’d purchased it especially for Finn, since the gym didn’t have helmets in styles that would fit magicats.

When they’re ready to head out of the locker room to the climbing area she reaches her hand down to tickle under their chin and

says, “Plus I think you look cute and I want pictures.”

They groan again, long suffering and miserable, which ends pretty quickly upon seeing the rock wall.

Adora steps up and grabs the length of cable running up to a pulley on the ceiling and hooks both of them in to start belaying. Finn is off and up the wall before she can even blink, zooming ahead with their tail flicking. Adora had started them off on a pretty advanced track because, though Finn hadn’t been rock climbing before, they were skilled enough at climbing that she figured they would appreciate the strange shaped hand holds and their increased spacing.

Catra finds a bench to sit on so she can observe the way they interact with each other, content to take in the smiles on their faces and the pride in Adora’s eyes. She can tell the woman is genuinely proud of each and every one of Finn’s accomplishments, and that Finn thrives on the affection and praise that Adora gives them for it.

More than one prospective partner had treated Finn like an afterthought, an inconvenience, an obstacle. And while she got that for some of them a child wouldn’t be a deal breaker but wasn’t something they were excited about, it still sucked to get so far with someone just for them to act like they didn’t even need to *speak* to her child. From the very start Adora made it clear that her relationship with Finn was just as important as her relationship with Catra, and it was so refreshing to finally be with someone that would be receptive to just how much she could gush about her baby.

They helped out with little things, like picking them up from school and doing homework, making dinner and taking baths. Somewhere along the line it stopped feeling like Adora was babysitting her kid, and felt more like she was co-parenting.

She and Finn had worked on a little something to help solidify it a little bit more for Adora, and she was filled with nervous and

excited anticipation to see how she would react.

“Mommy look!” She cranes her neck to see Finn at the very top of the wall. They’re hanging there, hovering freely in the air and knowing they were safe because Adora was holding them up. She is holding the rope firmly, cheering from below.

Catra gives them a thumbs up and blows them a kiss, rewarded by their beaming smile. She gets up to walk over and stand next to Adora who is concentrating on letting Finn down carefully.

As soon as their feet hit the ground Adora unhooks them from the rope and they run to leap into Catra’s arms.

“Did you see me? I was so high!”

She holds them up with one hand and raps her knuckles on their helmet with the other.

“I sure did! You got all the way up there so fast!” She says.

“They’re the fastest climber I have ever met!” Adora joins in, coming up next to them and placing one hand on the small of Catra’s back and the other on Finn’s shoulder. They both lean into her, purring, and the little family stands there for just a moment longer before Finn locks eyes with Adora and a mischievous smirk spreads across their face.

“Mommy climbs faster,” They say.

Adora grins back.

Catra wonders how she’s going to survive being surrounded by absolute trouble makers, ignoring the fact that Finn most certainly got it from her.

Adora leans over to blow playfully at the very tip of Finn’s ear and giggles when it twitches away.

“Well let’s see how fast Mommy is.”

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The last rays of sun have finally set through the trees, long shadows streaking the room in orange slowly dissipating into a cloak of night. They had just finished eating dinner, Adora having made Catra's favorite salmon dish, and Finn was sleepy enough from the day's excitement and their full belly to be snuggled into Adora's chest.

Their freshly clean hair tickled her nose, but she didn't dare move them. As soon as Adora had finished up their bath and ran Catra's for her, she'd gotten Finn dressed and moved out to the living room to lounge on the couch where they had promptly curled into her and purred themself to sleep.

Her arms are wrapped around them, holding them securely to her. The vibration soothes her, and her heart soars with the love she feels for this baby. She doesn't know what she did to deserve this family, but she thanks her lucky stars every day for giving her a partner like Catra and a child like Finn.

She strokes up and down their back, scritching at that spot between their shoulder blades that made them start to knead at her shirt.

They love her, and she loves them.

"They're such a fluff ball after bath time."

Adora looks up and see's Catra in the arch of the hall. She's got her hair pulled up in a ponytail, some loose curls framing her face. Her shirt, well Adora's shirt, hung off of one shoulder to expose the taught, wiry muscle coiled below her skin. She's in the shortest pair of sleep shorts she owns and Adora gulps, thinking about just how badly she wants to run her hand up Catra's silky thigh.

"Done with your bath already?" She whispers back.

She'd included Catra's favorite fur conditioner and a few choices of bath bomb along the side of the bathtub and was a little surprised that her relaxation was cut short.

"I loved the bath, and I relaxed in there for a little bit. What do you say we go hop in bed?"

Adora nods, standing in a smooth motion with Finn cradled in her arms. She follows Catra down the hall to their bedroom and places Finn down in the very center of the bed, pulling the blankets back up around them so they can snuggle down into the cocoon. She changes into some shorts and a tank top of her own and soon they're both crawling in to lay with Finn between them.

"Happy Mother's Day baby," Adora whispers in the quiet darkness of the room.

A tiny voice, coated in sleep, mumbles out between them, "Happy Mother's Day Mommy. Happy Mother's Day Mama."

Adora's eyes widen, stunned.

"Did they just?" She asks, looking at Catra.

She's nodding.

"Yeah. They've wanted to call you that for a while I think."

Adora scoops her arm under them and pulls them tight to her chest, nuzzling her face into the top of their head.

"I love you baby," And Catra can tell that, while the words certainly applied, in this instance they weren't meant for her.

"Really?" They seem to perk up, waking just a little more to blink blearily up at Adora, at their Mama. Their eyes are sleep clouded, but the blue shines through and strikes Adora to her core.

"Yeah sweetheart, I really do," She says, brushing her fingers along their forehead.

They turn their head and yawn, ears flicking and back arching, and say to Catra, "Mommy get the present."

Catra chuckles, if nothing else than to avoid crying even more today at how sweet her partner and *their* child is. She turns over and reaches into her bedside table to pull out an envelope and a small jewelry box.

"We were going to give this to you today and make it a little more climactic, but they were just having so much fun I didn't think it was worth stopping to come home early."

She hands the envelope over first and Finn is wide awake now, biting their lip.

"It's from me, but Mommy wrote it since my handwriting doesn't look too good yet."

It's kind of hard to hold a pencil when you're still learning how to keep your claws in check.

She opens it carefully and pulls out a card, pink construction paper and black sharpie with sparkly stickers all over it.

Dear Mama,

Thank you for joining our family and for making Mommy happy.

Thank you for the bath times, the bedtime stories, playing with me, helping me with my homework, and being here for me and Mommy whenever we need you.

Mommy will always be my favorite Mommy, but you're my favorite Mama.

Love,
Finn

Adora is sobbing now, clutching her *child* to her chest and reaching out to wrap an arm around her partner. Finn is *hers* and

she can hardly process the wall of emotion that hits her.

“I love you Finny. I love you so much and I am honored to be your Mama.”

It takes a while for her to calm down, reeling from the sudden and unexpected moment that she feels like she really became a mother. When she finally pulls back to look at Catra, the woman moves to open the jewelry box so Adora doesn't have to let go of either of them.

It's a necklace, a beautiful gemstone in the middle of a piece of swirling, woven silver.

"It's Finn's birthstone. So they're always with you."

Adora doesn't say anything, just continues to run her fingers through Finn's hair. She didn't have words for this feeling, but sometimes there just weren't words that were powerful enough. If she had ever experienced one of those moments, this is certainly worthy of it. Finn is rubbing their face all over her shoulder, collar bone, and neck. Even though the only other person she would see is here in bed with them, it's still instinct to scent mark their family like this.

"I love you both so much," Is all she can repeat, over and over again.

Catra snuggles in further, bringing the blankets around them tighter in their little nest while they settle in for the night, for real this time.

Adora woke up this morning to celebrate Mother's Day with Catra.

She had no idea it would be her first Mother's Day, too.

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